Contact

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www.linkedin.com/in/mila-c (LinkedIn)
www.mintconditionhomes.net (Company)
www.wreckingbelle.com (Company)
www.facebook.com/MintConditionHomes (Blog)

Top Skills

Contract Management
Operation
Change Management

Languages

English (Native or Bilingual)
Spanish (Professional Working)
Serbo-Croatian (Native or Bilingual)

Certifications

Realtor®
Building Analyst Professional
Licensed Building Contractor
Certified Green Building Professional
Certified RRP Renovator

Honors-Awards

Certificate of Special Congressional Recognition
2015 40 Under 40 Award
Leadership Palo Alto Fellow
2013 Partners in Preservation Award - Overall Vision
Certificate of Commendation

Publications

One Green Renovation Tip & Your Inner Pragmatist Will Thank Me Later
The Manzanita Report

Mila Cavala

Pilotage and Special Projects
Palo Alto, California, United States

Summary

Trained as an architect, I design solutions for today's challenges to shape tomorrow's future. My background is diverse across sectors and industries. I explore compelling ideas & build collaboratively with people.

Experience

Manzanita Works
Chief Executive Officer
November 2020 - Present (5 years 7 months)
Palo Alto, California, United States

Manzanita Works supports the welfare of workers and their families to live fruitful, dignified lives. Through the creation of novel consortiums in transit, childcare, housing, health, food and the future of work, we design distribution networks for the essential workforce which were critical during the COVID-19 pandemic and are still relevant today to close social safety net gaps and address disaster prevention. Our vision is to create a thriving regional workforce in collaboration with public and private partners.

Manzanita Works is a fiscally sponsored project of Philanthropic Ventures Foundation in Oakland, CA. Previously known as Bay Area Forward, we have supported community-led efforts to create housing and transportation options in the San Francisco Bay Area since 2014.

Edge Collaborative
Advisor, Special Projects
January 2024 - July 2025 (1 year 7 months)
Stockton, California, United States

Edge Collaborative, a San Joaquin Community Foundation fiscally sponsored project, partners with organizations by deploying capital and providing support with talent, policy, and coalition-building in workforce development, climate/green economy, and community wealth arenas.

As Advisor, Special Projects, I provided direct project support to Edge's CEO on a range of operational needs and acted as Interim Project Manager for community benefit plans in a United States Department of Energy FEED study of carbon capture technology and barge transport in the San Joaquin River-Stockton Deepwater Shipping Channel.

California State Assembly

District Director, Office of Assemblymember Marc Berman

September 2022 - January 2024 (1 year 5 months)

Palo Alto, California, United States

I served as a liaison between the Assemblymember and the communities of Saratoga, Sunnyvale, West San Jose, Mountain View, Campbell, Cupertino, Los Altos, Los Altos Hills, Palo Alto, Menlo Park, East Palo Alto, Portola Valley, Atherton, Woodside, portions of unincorporated Santa Clara and San Mateo Counties including North Fair Oaks, and the Coastside from Pacifica down to Pescadero.

As District Director, I developed the communication, public relations and constituent service strategy for the Office of Assemblymember Marc Berman. This included: recruited, trained and supervised a team of professionals that represents the Assemblymember in the community; coach, mentor and managed team to achieve community engagement goals; cultivated working relationships with key stakeholders in the business, education, non-profit and government sectors; served as primary point of contact for federal, state and local elected officials and staff; formulated and lead key local policy initiatives and collaborated with the Capitol staff to ensure district interests are addressed; advised the Assemblymember on local issues, politics and policy and executed on strategy; and represented and articulated the Assemblymember's legislative priorities through various public and private venues.

Palantir Technologies

Community Ambassador

June 2015 - December 2019 (4 years 7 months)

Palo Alto, CA

Palantir is a mission-focused company building products that make people better at their most important work. The team is dedicated to working for the common good and doing what's right, in addition to being deeply passionate about building great software and a successful company.

As Palantir's Community Ambassador, I explored how businesses integrated within an urban fabric could help cities thrive long term through employee community service, corporate giving for local initiatives, philanthropic in kind services and education programs which demonstrated Palantir’s values in collaboration with community stakeholders.

With a portfolio that covered partnerships on public education, homelessness, juvenile mental health, veterans affairs, workforce development, transportation, public art and the future of work, I led a major community initiative on developing best practices for closing gaps in public transit using first- and last-leg employer-led public-private partnerships. Culminating with a series of dialogues known as the "Manzanita Talks" between eight global tech companies and elected officials from eight silicon valley municipalities hosted by the regional think tank, Joint Venture Silicon Valley, these talks produced the "Manzanita Report" and received commendations from both the Santa Clara County Board of Supervisors President as well as the entire board of the San Mateo County Board of Supervisors.

InnVision Shelter Network
Director of Real Estate & Facilities
April 2013 - March 2015 (2 years)
Menlo Park, CA

I was part of the senior leadership team for InnVision Shelter Network (IVSN), a leading homeless services & housing provider in San Mateo and Santa Clara Counties.

In my role as Director of Real Estate and Facilities, I oversaw the acquisition, rehabilitation, operation and disposition of IVSN's real estate assets, a portfolio valued at approximately $20m that spans 17 sites from San Jose to Daly City.

Previously, I served as IVSN's Director of Strategic Relations, spearheading the organization's post-merger government relations effort as the lead spokesperson and relationship manager for local government, nonprofit and community advocate partners.

Mint Condition Homes, LLC
Principal
2007 - 2014 (7 years)
Oakland, CA

As Principal of Mint Condition Homes, LLC, an urban redevelopment company that transformed distressed properties into quality, affordable housing.
I managed privately offered real estate investment portfolios valued at approximately $2m, generating $12.5m in volume sales which helped stabilize declining neighborhoods in a volatile market.

Mint Condition Homes was recognized four years in a row by the Oakland Heritage Alliance with their “Partners in Preservation Award” (2010, 2011, 2012, 2013), was named Build It Green’s “Green Building Champion of 2010”, and was honored to receive a Resolution of Recognition from the Oakland City Council in 2011 for social entrepreneurship that incorporated green design practices.

Wrecking Belle, Inc.
Contractor
2006 - 2014 (8 years)
Oakland, CA

In concert with my design & development work, I founded Wrecking Belle, Inc., a licensed residential construction company that served the San Francisco Bay Area. As a licensed general building contractor, I cultivated a skilled and dedicated team that took on a variety of projects for real estate investors and home owners including whole house renovations and additions.

The Stone Company
Realtor®
2006 - January 2013 (7 years)
Oakland, CA

Real estate sales license specializing in residential acquisitions & sales with a particular emphasis on REO, Short Sales, auction properties, tenancy in common (TIC) and condo conversions.

Tough Love Artist Management, Inc.
Partner
July 2002 - April 2010 (7 years 10 months)
San Francisco, California, United States

Business management and development for the full service management company Tough Love Artist Management representing artists such as: Josh Ritter, The Submarines, Bird Monster, Dawn Landes, Sam Kassirer, Great North Sound Society Studio, Jason Isbell & The 400. Oversaw branding design, account portfolio growth, intellectual property matters, "street team"

mobilization of fans for merchandizing campaigns and tour promotion, internal operations and personnel management. In 2008, launched the media consulting services company Tough Love Industries.

Euro-Profile / iProfile
Business Management
February 2007 - April 2008 (1 year 3 months)
Palo Alto, California, United States

Supported the finance team to create systems, document, and manage pursue accounts receivable for this information services company. Euro-Profile had exceptionally fast bootstrapped growth, creating research centers in Pittsburgh and Manilla and selling to customers the world over. Euro-Profile acquired iProfile and then the combined entity was sold to a Private Equity fund in Austin in 2010.

RS Donahue Architects
Designer
2006 - 2007 (1 year)
Oakland, CA

Residential architectural design with a focus on single family home additions.

The Green Roundtable
Program Director
2002 - 2004 (2 years)
Cambridge, MA

As Program Director and the first full time staff member of Barbra Batshalom's pioneering organization, The Green Roundtable, I helped launch and grow this influential nonprofit dedicated to mainstreaming green design through education, policy and technical assistance.

Key projects included:
- City of Cambridge Green Building Guidelines
- Woburn Green Schools Feasibility Study
- Multi-disciplinary roundtable discussion groups, workshops, and design charrettes

Panop.com
Executive Administrative Assistant To Chief Executive Officer
June 2000 - October 2000 (5 months)
Palo Alto, California, United States

Supported the CEO and CTO of Panopticon, a product discovery and recommendation platform, through the acquisition of the company by Broadbase for over $100 million.

Education

Rhode Island School of Design

B. Arch. & BFA, Architecture · (1998 - 2001)

Carleton College

· (1995 - 1997)